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Insertion devices

Abstract

A cannula for passing surgical instruments through tissue. In some instances, the cannula may include a distal flange flexible between a radial configuration and a longitudinal configuration. In some instances, the cannula may also include an actuator configured to move the distal flange between the radial configuration and the longitudinal configuration. In some instances, the cannula may include a valve disposed within the lumen of the cannula, and a cap configured to secure the valve to the cannula. The valve may include a body member having a base and first and second opposing walls extending from the base. In some instances, the valve has an arcuate cutout in the lower surface configured to fit around an instrument shaft inserted therethrough. In some instance, the cannula includes a slit extending an entire length of the cannular to permit an instrument shaft to be inserted and/or removed laterally.

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Background/Summary

CROSS REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application is a continuation of International Application No. PCT/US2021/018221, filed Feb. 16, 2021, titled INSERTION DEVICES INCLUDING CANNULAE AND ASSOCIATED DUCKBILL VALVES, which claims the benefit of and priority to U.S. Provisional Patent Application Ser. No. 62/977,879, filed on Feb. 18, 2020, titled ACTUATABLE CANNULA, U.S. Provisional Patent Application Ser. No. 62/991,968, filed on Mar. 19, 2020, titled DUCKBILL VALVE, U.S. Provisional Patent Application Ser. No. 62/991,928, filed Mar. 19, 2020, titled FLEXIBLE CANNULA WITH OBTURATOR, and U.S. Provisional Patent Application Ser. No. 63/020,309, filed May 5, 2020, titled REGENETEN NEXTGEN MULTISHOT TENDON ANCHOR INSERTER CANNULA, the disclosures of which are incorporated herein by reference.

BACKGROUND

(1) Arthroscopic and endoscopic surgical procedures allow closed surgery to be performed via portals through which a variety of instruments may be passed to gain access to an internal surgical work site. Accordingly, a cannula may be used to pass instruments into the surgical work site. Furthermore, many arthroscopic procedures require the use of fluid to distend and irrigate the joint being operated upon, so in such instances the cannula must provide a sealed passageway in order to enable instruments to be passed into and out of the cannula while maintaining a fluid seal whether or not an instrument is in the cannula passageway.

SUMMARY

(2) This disclosure provides design, material, and use alternatives for medical devices for arthroscopic or endoscopic procedures.

(3) An example cannula for passing surgical instruments through tissue includes an elongated body having a first end, a second end, and a lumen extending along a longitudinal axis therebetween, a first flange extending radially outward from the first end, a second flange extending radially outward from the second end, the second flange configured to move between a first radially oriented configuration and a second longitudinally oriented configuration, and an actuator configured to move the second flange between the first radially oriented configuration and the second longitudinally oriented configuration.

(4) Alternatively or additionally to the embodiment above, the second flange is biased in the first radially oriented configuration.

(5) Alternatively or additionally to the embodiments above, the first radially oriented configuration is an equilibrium position.

(6) Alternatively or additionally to any of the embodiments above, the second flange includes a plurality of notches cut into an outer perimeter thereof, wherein when the second flange is moved to the second longitudinally oriented configuration, edges of the second flange between adjacent notches move together, narrowing gaps defined by the notches.

(7) Alternatively or additionally to any of the embodiments above, the second flange includes a plurality of apertures disposed adjacent the elongated body.

(8) Alternatively or additionally to any of the embodiments above, the actuator includes a shaft and

a clamp, the shaft extending along the elongated body and the clamp attached to the shaft and extending at least partially around the elongated body.

(9) Alternatively or additionally to any of the embodiments above, the shaft extends through a hole in the first flange.

(10) Alternatively or additionally to any of the embodiments above, the clamp is slidable along the elongated body to move the second flange from the first radial configuration to the second longitudinally oriented configuration.

(11) Alternatively or additionally to any of the embodiments above, the actuator is configured to be actuated by applying a longitudinal force on a portion of the shaft extending longitudinally above the first flange.

(12) Alternatively or additionally to any of the embodiments above, the longitudinal force applied to the shaft moves the shaft and clamp longitudinally along the elongated body, the clamp moving the second flange into the second longitudinally oriented configuration.

(13) Alternatively or additionally to any of the embodiments above, the elongated body is cylindrical and the clamp extends at least partially around a circumference of the elongated body.

(14) Alternatively or additionally to any of the embodiments above, the elongated body is cylindrical and the clamp is an annular collar extending at least partially around a circumference of the elongated body.

(15) Alternatively or additionally to any of the embodiments above, the actuator includes a plurality of shafts spaced apart around the elongated body and connected to the clamp.

(16) Alternatively or additionally to any of the embodiments above, the cannula further includes a ring connecting the plurality of shafts above the first flange.

(17) Alternatively or additionally to any of the embodiments above, the cannula further includes a first valve disposed within the elongated body.

(18) Alternatively or additionally to any of the embodiments above, the first flange includes a second valve.

(19) Another example cannula for passing surgical instruments through tissue includes a tubular body defining a lumen, a first flange extending radially outward from a first end of the tubular body, a second flange extending radially outward from a second end of the tubular body, the second flange having a plurality of notches cut into an outer perimeter thereof, and an actuator slidably coupled to the tubular body and configured to move the second flange from a first configuration in which the second flange extends radially outward from the tubular body, to a second configuration in which the second flange extends longitudinally away from the second end of the tubular body.

(20) Alternatively or additionally to any of the embodiments above, the actuator includes at least one shaft extending along an outer surface of the tubular body, and a clamp attached to the shaft, the clamp extending around at least a portion of an outer circumference of the tubular body.

(21) Alternatively or additionally to any of the embodiments above, a first end of the shaft extends through an opening in the first flange and the clamp is attached to a second end of the shaft, wherein applying a longitudinal force to the first end of the shaft moves the shaft along the tubular body and the clamp pushes the second flange from the first configuration into the second configuration.

(22) Alternatively or additionally to any of the embodiments above, the tubular body includes at least a first valve.

(23) Alternatively or additionally to any of the embodiments above, the first flange includes a second valve.

(24) A further example cannula for passing surgical instruments through tissue includes a tubular body having a first end and a second opposite end, the tubular body defining a longitudinal lumen extending between the first and second ends, a first flange extending radially outward at the first end of the tubular body, a second flange disposed at the second end of the tubular body, the second flange biased in a first configuration in which the second flange extends radially outward from the

tubular body, the second flange moveable to a second configuration in which the second flange collapses radially inward and distal of the tubular body, wherein when in the second configuration, the second flange has an outer diameter substantially the same as an outer diameter of the tubular body, and an actuator slidably coupled to the tubular body, the actuator configured to move the second flange from the first configuration to the second configuration.

(25) An example cannula for passing surgical instruments through tissue includes an elongated body having a distal end, a proximal end, and a lumen extending along a longitudinal axis therebetween, a flange extending radially outward from the distal end, a valve disposed within the lumen of the elongated body adjacent the proximal end, and a cap configured to be disposed over the proximal end of the elongated body, the cap configured to secure the valve to the elongated body, the cap engaging the valve to create a non-compressive seal therebetween.

(26) Alternatively or additionally to the embodiment above, a proximal surface of the valve has a first mating geometry and an inner surface of the cap has a second mating geometry, wherein the non-compressive seal is created between the valve and cap when the first mating geometry of the valve engages the second mating geometry of the cap.

(27) Alternatively or additionally to the embodiments above, the first mating geometry of the valve includes at least one ridge and the second mating geometry of the cap includes at least two ridges separated by a channel, wherein when the cap engages the valve, the at least one ridge on the valve is received within the channel on the cap.

(28) Alternatively or additionally to the embodiments above, the first mating geometry of the valve includes two ridges separated by a channel and the second mating geometry of the cap includes three ridges separated by two channels, wherein when the cap engages the valve, the two ridges on the valve are received within the two channels on the cap.

(29) Alternatively or additionally to the embodiments above, the cap is more flexible than the elongated body and the valve.

(30) Alternatively or additionally to the embodiments above, the elongated body is cylindrical and includes threading or a plurality of circumferential ribs disposed on an outer surface of the elongated body, the cannula further including a nut extending around a circumference of the elongated body, the nut configured to selectively engage the threading or ribs and to move between a first position in which the nut is disengaged from the threading or ribs, allowing the nut to slide axially along the elongated body, and a second position in which the nut engages the threading or ribs.

(31) Alternatively or additionally to the embodiments above, the threading or ribs are discontinuous and include at least one gap, the gaps of adjacent threads or ribs aligned longitudinally along a portion of the elongated body, wherein the nut has an inner circumference sized to move over the threading or ribs and at least one inwardly extending rigid projection, wherein when the nut is rotated such that the projection is aligned with the gaps, the nut slides axially along the elongated body, and when the nut is rotated such that the projection is not aligned with the gaps, the projection engages the threading or ribs and prevents the nut from moving axially along the elongated body.

(32) Alternatively or additionally to the embodiments above, the cannula further includes a stop disposed adjacent each gap, the stop configured to limit rotation of the projection.

(33) Alternatively or additionally to the embodiments above, the stop is an outwardly extending protrusion on the body.

(34) Alternatively or additionally to the embodiments above, the stop is a recess in an outer surface of the body, the recess configured to receive a portion of the projection.

(35) Alternatively or additionally to the embodiments above, the elongated body includes threading on the outer surface thereof, wherein the nut has an inner circumference sized to move over the threading and at least one inwardly extending rigid projection configured to engage the threading on the outer surface of the elongated body such that rotation of the nut allows the nut to move

axially along the elongated body.

(36) Alternatively or additionally to the embodiments above, the threading includes a plurality of discontinuous helical turns with a gap in each helical turn, the gaps aligned longitudinally, wherein when the nut is rotated such that the projection is aligned with the gaps, the nut slides axially along the elongated body without rotating, and when the nut is positioned between adjacent ribs and rotated such that the projection is not aligned with the gaps, the at least one projection engages the threading, requiring the nut to be rotated in order to move axially along the elongated body.

(37) Alternatively or additionally to the embodiments above, the flange is wedge shaped with a flat proximal surface and an angled distal surface.

(38) Another example cannula for passing surgical instruments through tissue includes an elongated body having a distal end, a proximal end, and a lumen extending along a longitudinal axis therebetween, a valve disposed within the lumen of the elongated body adjacent the proximal end, and a cap configured to be disposed over the proximal end of the elongated body, the cap configured to secure the valve to the elongated body, wherein a proximal surface of the valve has a first mating geometry and an inner surface of the cap has a second mating geometry, wherein a seal is created between the valve and cap when the first mating geometry of the valve engages the second mating geometry of the cap, wherein the proximal surface of the valve and the inner surface of the cap are both non-linear.

(39) Alternatively or additionally to the embodiment above, the elongated body is cylindrical and includes threading or a plurality of circumferential ribs disposed on an outer surface of the elongated body, the cannula further including a nut extending around a circumference of the elongated body, the nut configured to selectively engage the threading or ribs and to move between a first position in which the nut is disengaged from the threading or ribs, allowing the nut to slide axially along the elongated body, and a second position in which the nut engages the threading or ribs.

(40) Alternatively or additionally to the embodiments above, the threading or ribs are discontinuous and include a plurality of gaps aligned longitudinally along the elongated body, wherein the nut has an inner circumference sized to move over the threading or ribs and at least one inwardly extending rigid projection, wherein when the nut is rotated such that the projection is aligned with the gaps, the nut slides axially along the elongated body, and when the nut is rotated such that the projection is not aligned with the gaps, the projection engages the threading or ribs.

(41) Alternatively or additionally to the embodiments above, the cannula further includes a stop disposed adjacent each gap, the stop configured to limit rotation of the rigid projection.

(42) Another example cannula for passing surgical instruments through tissue includes an elongated cylindrical body having a distal end, a proximal end, and a lumen extending along a longitudinal axis therebetween, the elongated cylindrical body including threading or a plurality of circumferential ribs disposed on an outer surface of the elongated cylindrical body, a nut extending around a circumference of the elongated cylindrical body, the nut configured to selectively engage the threading or ribs and to move between a first position in which the nut is disengaged from the threading or ribs, allowing the nut to slide axially along the elongated body, and a second position in which the nut engages the threading or ribs, at least one valve disposed within the lumen of the elongated body adjacent the proximal end, and a cap configured to be disposed over the proximal end of the elongated body, the cap configured to secure the at least one valve to the elongated body, the cap engaging the at least one valve to create a non-compressive seal therebetween.

(43) Alternatively or additionally to the embodiment above, the threading or ribs are discontinuous and include a plurality of gaps aligned longitudinally along the elongated body, wherein the nut has an inner circumference sized to move over the threading or ribs and at least one inwardly extending rigid projection, wherein when the nut is rotated such that the projection is aligned with the gaps, the nut slides axially along the elongated cylindrical body, and when the nut is rotated such that the projection is not aligned with the gaps, the projection engages the threading or ribs.

- (44) Alternatively or additionally to the embodiments above, the cannula further includes a stop disposed adjacent each gap, the stop configured to limit rotation of the rigid projection.
- (45) Another exemplary embodiment is an access cannula. The access cannula includes an elongate body defining an access lumen extending therethrough and a valve disposed in the access lumen. The valve includes a body member having a base and first and second opposing walls extending from the base. The first and second walls have first ends spaced apart at the base and second ends converging at a lower surface. The lower surface has a length and includes a slit extending at least partially along the length of the lower surface. The body member defines an axial passageway from the base to the lower surface through the slit. The valve also includes an arcuate cutout in the lower surface centered on a central axis of the body member. The arcuate cutout has a radius less than half the length of the lower surface of the first and second walls.
- (46) Alternatively or additionally to any embodiment herein, a length of the slit is less than the length of the lower surface.
- (47) Alternatively or additionally to any embodiment herein, a length of the slit is 4 times or less than the radius of the arcuate cutout.
- (48) Alternatively or additionally to any embodiment herein, the length of the slit is less than or equal to twice the radius of the arcuate cutout.
- (49) Alternatively or additionally to any embodiment herein, the lower surface is substantially perpendicular to the central axis.
- (50) Alternatively or additionally to any embodiment herein, the inner surfaces of the first and second walls are devoid of projections or depressions.
- (51) Alternatively or additionally to any embodiment herein, a depth of the arcuate cutout is equal to the radius of the arcuate cutout.
- (52) Alternatively or additionally to any embodiment herein, a depth of the arcuate cutout is greater than the radius of the arcuate cutout.
- (53) Alternatively or additionally to any embodiment herein, the first and second walls have a constant wall thickness from their first ends to their second ends.
- (54) Alternatively or additionally to any embodiment herein, a lower end face of each of the first and second walls has a constant wall thickness from a first end of the slit, along the arcuate cutout to a second end of the slit.
- (55) Alternatively or additionally to any embodiment herein, the base includes a circumferential flange extending beyond a width of the body member.
- (56) Alternatively or additionally to any embodiment herein, the radius of the arcuate cutout is between 0.05 inches and 0.2 inches.
- (57) Alternatively or additionally to any embodiment herein, the length of the lower surface is between 0.5 inches and 1 inch.
- (58) Another exemplary embodiment is an access cannula including an elongate body defining an access lumen extending therethrough and a duckbill valve disposed in the access lumen. The duckbill valve includes a body member having a base and first and second opposing walls having first ends spaced apart at the base and second ends converging at a lower surface. The lower surface has a length and includes a slit extending only partially along the length of the lower surface. The body member defines an axial passageway from the base to the lower surface through the slit. The inner surfaces of the first and second walls are devoid of projections or depressions. The valve also includes an arcuate cutout in the second ends of the first and second walls. The arcuate cutout has a radius less than half the length of the lower surface of the first and second walls.
- (59) Alternatively or additionally to any embodiment herein, a length of the slit is 4 times or less than the radius of the arcuate cutout.
- (60) Alternatively or additionally to any embodiment herein, the lower surface is substantially perpendicular to a central axis of the body member.

- (61) Alternatively or additionally to any embodiment herein, the first and second walls have a constant wall thickness from their first ends to their second ends.
- (62) Alternatively or additionally to any embodiment herein, a lower end face of each of the first and second walls has a constant wall thickness from a first end of the slit, along the arcuate cutout to a second end of the slit.
- (63) Alternatively or additionally to any embodiment herein, the radius of the arcuate cutout is between 0.05 inches and 0.2 inches and the length of the lower surface is between 0.5 inches and 1 inch.
- (64) Yet another exemplary embodiment is an access cannula including an elongate body defining an access lumen extending therethrough and a duckbill valve disposed in the access lumen. The duckbill valve includes a body member having a base and first and second opposing walls having first ends spaced apart at the base and second ends converging at a lower surface. The lower surface has a length. A slit is located between the second ends of the first and second opposing walls at the lower surface. The slit has a length less than the length of the lower surface such that the slit extends only partially along the length of the lower surface. The body member defines an axial passageway from the base to the lower surface through the slit. The valve also includes an arcuate cutout in the second ends of the first and second walls. The arcuate cutout has a length measured along the length of the lower surface of the first and second walls. The length of the slit is less than or equal to the length of the arcuate cutout.
- (65) A further exemplary embodiment is a cannula comprising a flexible shaft having a distal end and a proximal end and a slit extending between the distal end and the proximal end.
- (66) Alternatively or additionally to any embodiment herein, the proximal end of the flexible shaft may be flared.
- (67) Yet a further exemplary embodiment is a cannula comprising a flexible shaft having a distal end and a proximal end, a slit extending along an entire length of the flexible shaft from the distal end to the proximal end, and a flared region located at the proximal end. The cannula is configured to be positionable around an elongate shaft of a medical device to be inserted through an incision simultaneously with the elongate shaft of the medical device acting as an obturator and then removed therefrom by passing the elongate shaft of the medical device laterally through the slit.
- (68) The above summary of some embodiments is not intended to describe each disclosed embodiment or every implementation of the present disclosure. The Figures, and Detailed Description, which follow, more particularly exemplify some of these embodiments.
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Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) In the drawings, which are not necessarily drawn to scale, like numerals may describe similar components in different views. Like numerals having different letter suffixes may represent different instances of similar components. The drawings illustrate generally, by way of example, but not by way of limitation, various embodiments discussed in the present document.
- (2) FIGS. 1A, 1B, and 1C illustrate the insertion of a prior art cannula;
- (3) FIG. 2 is a perspective view of an exemplary cannula;
- (4) FIG. 3 is a perspective view of the cannula of FIG. 2 without the actuator and with the distal flange in the second configuration;
- (5) FIG. 4 is a side view of the cannula of FIG. 2 with the actuator in the second position;
- (6) FIG. 5 is a perspective view of another exemplary cannula;
- (7) FIG. 6 is a side cross-sectional view of the cannula of FIG. 2;
- (8) FIG. 7 is a perspective transparent view of the cannula of FIG. 2 without the actuator;
- (9) FIG. 8 is a perspective view of another exemplary cannula;

- (10) FIG. 9 is a side view of the cannula of FIG. 8 on an obturator;
- (11) FIG. 10 is a cross-sectional view of the cannula of FIG. 8, taken along line 10-10;
- (12) FIGS. 11A and 11B are perspective views of the valve shown in FIG. 10;
- (13) FIG. 12 is an enlarged view of the cap shown in FIG. 10;
- (14) FIG. 13 is a perspective view of a further exemplary cannula;
- (15) FIG. 14 is a cross-sectional view of the cannula of FIG. 13, taken along line 14-14;
- (16) FIG. 15 is an exploded view of the cannula of FIG. 13;
- (17) FIG. 16A is a perspective view of an exemplary elongate body of a cannula with a nut disposed thereon in a first position;
- (18) FIG. 16B is a perspective view of the elongate body of a cannula shown in FIG. 16A with the nut disposed thereon in a second position;
- (19) FIGS. 17A and 17B are top views of exemplary nuts with two and three projections, respectively;
- (20) FIG. 18 is a perspective view of an exemplary elongate body with external threading;
- (21) FIG. 19 is a side view of an exemplary elongate body with external threading and stops;
- (22) FIG. 20A is a perspective view of another exemplary elongate body with external ribs and stops;
- (23) FIG. 20B is a cross-sectional view of the elongate body of FIG. 20A, taken along line 20B-20B;
- (24) FIG. 21A is a perspective view of another exemplary elongate body of a cannula with external angled ribs and stops with a nut disposed thereon;
- (25) FIG. 21B is a cross-sectional view of the elongate body of FIG. 21A, taken along line 21B-21B;
- (26) FIG. 21C is a cross-sectional view of the elongate body of FIG. 21A, taken along line 21C-21C;
- (27) FIG. 22A is a perspective view of another exemplary elongate body of a cannula with external rounded circumferential ribs with a nut disposed thereon;
- (28) FIG. 22B is a cross-sectional view of the elongate body of FIG. 22A, taken along line 22B-22B;
- (29) FIG. 23 is a perspective view of an exemplary valve;
- (30) FIG. 23A is an enlarged perspective view of a portion of the valve of FIG. 23;
- (31) FIG. 24A is an end view of the valve of FIG. 23;
- (32) FIG. 24B is an end view of another exemplary valve;
- (33) FIG. 25A is a side view of the valve of FIG. 23;
- (34) FIG. 25B is a side view of a variation of the valve of FIG. 23;
- (35) FIG. 26 is a cross-sectional view of the valve of FIG. 24A taken along line 26-26;
- (36) FIG. 27 is a cross-sectional view of the valve of FIG. 24A taken along line 27-27;
- (37) FIG. 28 is a perspective view of the valve of FIG. 23 with an instrument inserted therethrough;
- (38) FIG. 29 is a perspective view of the valve of FIG. 23 in an access cannula;
- (39) FIG. 30 is a perspective view of another exemplary valve;
- (40) FIG. 31 is a perspective view of another exemplary cannula;
- (41) FIG. 32 is a perspective view of the cannula of FIG. 31 positioned on the shaft of a tissue stapler; and
- (42) FIGS. 33A-33C illustrate steps of inserting the combination of the cannula and tissue stapler of FIG. 32 into an incision of a patient.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(43) For the following defined terms, these definitions shall be applied, unless a different definition is given in the claims or elsewhere in this specification.

(44) All numeric values are herein assumed to be modified by the term “about,” whether or not explicitly indicated. The term “about”, in the context of numeric values, generally refers to a range

of numbers that one of skill in the art would consider equivalent to the recited value (e.g., having the same function or result). In many instances, the term “about” may include numbers that are rounded to the nearest significant figure. Other uses of the term “about” (e.g., in a context other than numeric values) may be assumed to have their ordinary and customary definition(s), as understood from and consistent with the context of the specification, unless otherwise specified.

(45) The recitation of numerical ranges by endpoints includes all numbers within that range, including the endpoints (e.g., 1 to 5 includes 1, 1.5, 2, 2.75, 3, 3.80, 4, and 5). Although some suitable dimensions, ranges, and/or values pertaining to various components, features and/or specifications are disclosed, one of skill in the art, incited by the present disclosure, would understand desired dimensions, ranges, and/or values may deviate from those expressly disclosed.

(46) As used in this specification and the appended claims, the singular forms “a”, “an”, and “the” include plural referents unless the content clearly dictates otherwise. As used in this specification and the appended claims, the term “or” is generally employed in its sense including “and/or” unless the content clearly dictates otherwise. It is to be noted that in order to facilitate understanding, certain features of the disclosure may be described in the singular, even though those features may be plural or recurring within the disclosed embodiment(s). Each instance of the features may include and/or be encompassed by the singular disclosure(s), unless expressly stated to the contrary. For simplicity and clarity purposes, not all elements of the disclosure are necessarily shown in each figure or discussed in detail below. However, it will be understood that the following discussion may apply equally to any and/or all of the components for which there are more than one, unless explicitly stated to the contrary. Additionally, not all instances of some elements or features may be shown in each figure for clarity.

(47) Relative terms such as “proximal”, “distal”, “advance”, “withdraw”, variants thereof, and the like, may be generally considered with respect to the positioning, direction, and/or operation of various elements relative to a user/operator/manipulator of the device, wherein “proximal” and “withdraw” indicate or refer to closer to or toward the user and “distal” and “advance” indicate or refer to farther from or away from the user. In some instances, the terms “proximal” and “distal” may be arbitrarily assigned in an effort to facilitate understanding of the disclosure, and such instances will be readily apparent to the skilled artisan. Other relative terms, such as “upstream”, “downstream”, “inflow”, and “outflow” refer to a direction of fluid flow within a lumen, such as a body lumen, a blood vessel, or within a device.

(48) The term “extent” may be understood to mean a greatest measurement of a stated or identified dimension, unless the extent or dimension in question is preceded by or identified as a “minimum”, which may be understood to mean a smallest measurement of the stated or identified dimension. For example, “outer extent” may be understood to mean a maximum outer dimension, “radial extent” may be understood to mean a maximum radial dimension, “longitudinal extent” may be understood to mean a maximum longitudinal dimension, etc. Each instance of an “extent” may be different (e.g., axial, longitudinal, lateral, radial, circumferential, etc.) and will be apparent to the skilled person from the context of the individual usage. Generally, an “extent” may be considered a greatest possible dimension measured according to the intended usage, while a “minimum extent” may be considered a smallest possible dimension measured according to the intended usage. In some instances, an “extent” may generally be measured orthogonally within a plane and/or cross-section, but may be, as will be apparent from the particular context, measured differently—such as, but not limited to, angularly, radially, circumferentially (e.g., along an arc), etc.

(49) The terms “monolithic” and “unitary” shall generally refer to an element or elements made from or consisting of a single structure or base unit/element. A monolithic and/or unitary element shall exclude structure and/or features made by assembling or otherwise joining multiple discrete elements together.

(50) It is noted that references in the specification to “an embodiment”, “some embodiments”, “other embodiments”, etc., indicate that the embodiment(s) described may include a particular

feature, structure, or characteristic, but every embodiment may not necessarily include the particular feature, structure, or characteristic. Moreover, such phrases are not necessarily referring to the same embodiment. Further, when a particular feature, structure, or characteristic is described in connection with an embodiment, it would be within the knowledge of one skilled in the art to effect the particular feature, structure, or characteristic in connection with other embodiments, whether or not explicitly described, unless clearly stated to the contrary. That is, the various individual elements described below, even if not explicitly shown in a particular combination, are nevertheless contemplated as being combinable or arrangeable with each other to form other additional embodiments or to complement and/or enrich the described embodiment(s), as would be understood by one of ordinary skill in the art.

(51) For the purpose of clarity, certain identifying numerical nomenclature (e.g., first, second, third, fourth, etc.) may be used throughout the description and/or claims to name and/or differentiate between various described and/or claimed features. It is to be understood that the numerical nomenclature is not intended to be limiting and is exemplary only. In some embodiments, alterations of and deviations from previously-used numerical nomenclature may be made in the interest of brevity and clarity. That is, a feature identified as a “first” element may later be referred to as a “second” element, a “third” element, etc. or may be omitted entirely, and/or a different feature may be referred to as the “first” element. The meaning and/or designation in each instance will be apparent to the skilled practitioner.

(52) The following description should be read with reference to the drawings, which are not necessarily to scale, wherein similar elements in different drawings are numbered the same. The detailed description and drawings are intended to illustrate but not limit the claimed invention. Those skilled in the art will recognize that the various elements described and/or shown may be arranged in various combinations and configurations without departing from the scope of the disclosure. The detailed description and drawings illustrate example embodiments of the claimed invention. However, in the interest of clarity and ease of understanding, while every feature and/or element may not be shown in each drawing, the feature(s) and/or element(s) may be understood to be present regardless, unless otherwise specified.

(53) During arthroscopic surgeries, such as rotator cuff repair surgery, visualization can be an issue due to limited real estate in the subacromial space. Proper cannula placement and in-vivo pressure can vastly improve the surgeon's ability to visualize the proper anatomy. The soft tissue in the subacromial space can hinder visualization by collapsing inward if proper pressure is not held within the joint space. Cannulas with sufficient valve systems can hold pressure within the joint space and allow the surgeon to operate freely without visualization issues.

(54) An arthroscopic fluid pump may be used to provide fluid distension to increase visibility and instrument navigation in the surgical site. The loss of fluid distension caused by leakage from surgical portals created to pass medical instruments into the surgical site is a problem often associated with the use of fluid distension and conventional cannulas. Excessive loss of fluid distension through these portals may lead to reduced visibility, reduced working space, and require the surgeon to increase fluid pressure output from the arthroscopic pump. Increasing fluid pressure is not desirable as it may increase the risk for patient complications. Rigid surgical cannulas have been used to prevent loss of fluid distension while allowing medical instruments to be passed through the surgical portals as needed. However, rigid cannulas may restrict instrument mobility, working space, and cause unintended damage to the patient.

(55) Proper cannula placement and in-vivo pressure can vastly improve the surgeon's ability to visualize the proper anatomy. The soft tissue in the subacromial space can hinder visualization by collapsing inward if proper pressure is not held within the joint space. Cannulas with sufficient valve systems can hold pressure within the joint space and allow the surgeon to operate freely without visualization issues.

(56) Prior art silicone cannulas are available in several lengths and diameters to account for

different anatomies and surgeon preferences. These cannulas are made of a flexible material to protect the anatomy during insertion and removal into the joint space. These cannulas have a distal flange to retract the soft tissue around the insertion area to improve visualization. They may have one or more valves to improve fluid dynamic capability.

(57) The prior art cannulas are often I-shaped, requiring the surgeon to fold the distal or inner flange in half and grasp it with an instrument such as a hemostat (FIG. 1A), insert the combined hemostat and cannula through the skin incision and into the joint space (FIG. 1B), and release and retract the hemostat (FIG. 1C). However, the use of the hemostat may be awkward for insertion and may necessitate a larger skin incision than would be required for the insertion of a cylindrical or T-shaped cannula.

(58) A cannula with a distal flange having relief slits or notches so the distal flange may transition from a distal flanged I-shaped cannula to a standard T-shaped cylindrical cannula has the advantage of being insertable into a skin incision without the use of a hemostat or other tool. Such a cannula **100** is shown in FIG. 2. The cannula **100** may include an elongated body **110** having a longitudinal axis, with a proximal flange **120** disposed at a first end of the body **110**, and a distal flange **130** disposed at a second end of the body **110**, and an actuator **160**. The body **110** defines a lumen **111** extending along the longitudinal axis (see FIG. 6). When inserted into a skin incision, the proximal flange **120** may sit outside the joint space, on the skin, and serve as the entry point for the necessary devices for the procedure. The distal flange **130** may sit inside the joint space and retract surrounding soft tissue to improve visualization inside the joint space. The body **110** is illustrated as a cylinder, with a round cross-section, however it will be understood that the cross-sectional shape of the body **110** may be another shape, such as, but not limited to, oval, teardrop, stadium, etc.

(59) The proximal flange **120** may extend radially outward from the first end of the body **110**, and the distal flange **130** may extend radially outward from the second end of the body **110**. The proximal flange **120** may help prevent over-insertion of the cannula **100** during the insertion process because the proximal flange **120** may be thicker than the distal flange **130**. The thicker proximal flange **120** may be difficult to fold or bend and pass through the incision and into the body. In an exemplary embodiment only, the thickness of the proximal flange **120** may be about twice the thickness of the distal flange **130**. Each of the proximal flange **120** and distal flange **130** may be generally circular as illustrated, or oval, teardrop, or stadium in shape, and may have similar or different shapes and diameters.

(60) The body **110**, proximal flange **120**, and distal flange **130** may be a monolithic element, formed as a single piece. In other examples, one or more of the body **110**, proximal flange **120**, and distal flange **130** may be formed from different materials. In one example, the body **110**, proximal flange **120**, and distal flange **130** are formed as a monolithic structure, made of a flexible polymeric material such as silicone or polyurethane.

(61) The distal flange **130** may have relief elements so that the flange may easily bend back and forth between a first radial configuration in which the distal flange **130** extends radially outward from the body **110**, as shown in FIG. 2, and a second longitudinal configuration in which the distal flange **130** is bent such that it extends longitudinally from the body **110**, as shown in FIG. 3. The distal flange **130** is biased in the first radial configuration. The actuator **160** is not shown in FIG. 3 in order to illustrate the configuration of the distal flange **130**, which may be substantially covered by the actuator **160** in the second configuration. In one example, the relief elements include a plurality of notches **132** cut into the outer perimeter **134** of the distal flange **130**. The notches **132** may extend radially inward from the outer perimeter **134** of the distal flange **130** at spaced apart circumferentially arranged locations. In some instances, the notches **132** may be triangular cuts with the widest part of the cut at the perimeter **134** of the distal flange **130**, as shown in FIG. 2. In other embodiments, the notches **132** may be circular, oval, or teardrop in shape, for example. The width and depth of each notch **132** as well as the number of notches **132** distributed around the

distal flange **130** may be selected to achieve a flange with sufficient integrity to maintain the first radially extended configuration when not compressed by the actuator, while still allowing the actuator **160** to move the distal flange **130** into the second configuration. In some instances, as adjacent sections **136** of the distal flange **130** move (e.g., bend, flex or deflect) into the second configuration, the notches **132** narrow until adjacent sections **136** are in direct contact with one another, creating a substantially tubular structure, as shown in FIG. 3.

(62) The relief elements may also include a plurality of apertures **138** extending transversely through the distal flange **130** from a proximal surface **131** to a distal surface **133** of the distal flange **130**. The apertures **138** may encourage the sections **136** of the distal flange **130** to pivot and bend/flex around the apertures **138** when pushed by the actuator **160**. The apertures **138** may be positioned circumferentially near the inner edge of the distal flange **130**, adjacent the body **110**. In some examples, each section **136** includes an aperture **138** proximate the base of the section **136**. The apertures **138** may be curved and may have a length extending along a majority of the inner portion of each section **136**, as illustrated in FIG. 2. In some examples, the distal flange **130** may have both notches **132** and apertures **138**. In some instances, the notches **132** may extend radially toward the radial position of the apertures **138** from the perimeter **134**. In some instances, the radial length of the notches **132** may be less than the radial distance between the perimeter **134** and the circumferentially arranged apertures **138**.

(63) At least the distal flange **130** may be comprised of a flexible polymeric material such as silicone or polyurethane, so that it may transition easily from a radially extending flange (FIG. 2) to a cylindrical wall (FIG. 3) having a radial extent less than the radial extent of the distal flange **130** in its radially extended configuration (FIG. 2), when acted upon by the actuator **160**.

(64) The distal flange **130** may be moved from the first, radially extended configuration to the second, deflected configuration through actuation of the actuator **160**, such as by axial sliding movement of the actuator **160**. The actuator **160** may include a shaft **162**, a clamp **164**, and a head **166**. The actuator **160** may be provided with the cannula **100**, such as included as an indispensable component of the cannula **100**. The shaft **162** may extend from the clamp **164** along a length of the body **110** of the cannula **100**, such that the medical personnel can manipulate the actuator **160** from the proximal end of the cannula **100** to cause the clamp **164** to bend or flex the distal flange **130** during use. For example, the shaft **162** may extend through a hole **122** in the proximal flange **120**, and along the body **110**. In some examples, the body **110** may have a longitudinal depression or groove **112** configured to receive the shaft **162** therealong. See FIG. 3. The proximal end of the shaft **162** may extend proximally or above the proximal flange **120**, and may have a head **166** larger than the shaft **162** to receive the user's thumb or finger for pushing or otherwise actuating the shaft **162**. The head **166** may also include ridges, grooves, or other texture to assist the user in grasping the head **166** to pull the actuator **160** proximally and release the distal flange **130** once the cannula **100** has been inserted. The distal end of the shaft **162** is attached or fixed to the clamp **164**. The clamp **164** may extend at least partially around the body **110**. In some examples, the body **110** is cylindrical and the clamp **164** may be an annular shaped collar extending partially or completely around the circumference of the body **110**. The shaft **162** and clamp **164** are slidable along the body **110** from a first position in which the distal flange **130** is in the first, radially extended configuration, to a second position in which the distal flange **130** is in the second, radially collapsed configuration. In some instance, the first, radially extended configuration may be an equilibrium position in which the distal flange **130** is not subjected to an external force, and the second, radially collapsed configuration may be a deflected position in which the distal flange **130** is subjected to an external force (i.e., a collapsing force applied by the clamp **164**).

(65) When the cannula **100** is to be inserted into a skin incision, the actuator **160** may be actuated to collapse the distal flange **130** radially inward to facilitate passage of the distal flange **130** through an incision or other portal gaining access to an interior cavity or anatomical space of a patient. For example, a longitudinal force is applied distally onto the head **166** of the shaft **162**,

which slides the shaft **162** and clamp **164** longitudinally along the body **110**, bending or deflecting the distal flange **130** into the second configuration, in which the distal flange **130** collapses radially inward and distally such that the distal flange **130** extends longitudinally and parallel to the central axis of the body **110**. See FIG. 3. The head **166** may prevent the shaft **162** from sliding through the proximal flange **120**. When the actuator **160** is in the second position, the head **166** may move toward the proximal flange **120** (e.g., the head **166** may rest on the proximal flange **120**) and the clamp **164** may cover (e.g., extend over, circumferentially surround, etc.) the distal flange **130**, as shown in FIG. 4. With the cannula **100** in the second configuration, the surgeon may deliver the cannula **100** into the joint space without the need to clamp the distal flange into a hemostat. When the cannula **100** is successfully in the joint space, the user will pull proximally on the head **166** of the actuator **160**, moving the actuator **160** back to the first position to release the distal flange **130** back into its first, radially extended configuration, as shown in FIG. 2.

(66) In another embodiment, the cannula **200** may include an actuator **260** with a plurality of shafts **262** spaced apart around the body **210** and connected to the clamp **264**, as shown in FIG. 5. The proximal ends of each shaft **262** may be connected to a ring **266**. The ring **266** may allow the surgeon to easily push all of the shafts **262** simultaneously, thereby providing a substantially equal longitudinal force on each shaft **262**. The plurality of shafts **262** may then provide an equal force around the circumference of the distal flange **230**, which may be advantageous when the distal flange **230** is thicker, has a greater diameter, or is stiffer.

(67) The cannula **100** may include at least one valve configured to prevent or limit the amount of fluid escaping through the lumen **111** of the cannula and to maintain the hydrostatic pressure inside the joint space. A first valve **114** may be located within the body **110** between the proximal flange **120** and the distal flange **130**, as shown in FIG. 6. The first valve **114** may prevent fluid from exiting out of the body when instruments are being inserted through the cannula **100**. The first valve **114** within the body **110** may be formed by one or more slits in a transverse member **116** extending across the lumen **111**. The first valve **114** may be formed by a single slit or two slits forming a cross. In some embodiments, a second valve **124** may be located in the proximal flange **120** to prevent fluid from exiting the body when the cannula **100** itself is being inserted into the body. The second valve **124** within the proximal flange **120** may be formed by one or more slits or a small opening extending through the proximal flange **120** into the lumen **111** of the body **110**. FIG. 7 is a transparent illustration of the cannula **100** with the actuator removed for clarity, showing the first valve **114** as two slits in the transverse member **116** forming a cross, and the second valve **124** as a small hole in the center of the proximal flange **120**.

(68) The transverse member **116** defining the first valve **114** may be made from a polymer material such as silicone, to substantially reduce the amount of tearing or wear as a result of insertion and/or withdrawal of sharp instruments. The transverse member **116** may be formed by injection molding, thus the entire cannula **100** may be made of the same material, such as silicone or polyurethane. In another example, at least the transverse member **116** may be made of polyisoprene. In another example, the body **110**, proximal flange **120**, and distal flange **130** may also be made of polyisoprene, such that the entire cannula **100** is made of a single material. Other natural or synthetic materials known to one of ordinary skill in the art, and that would substantially reduce the amount of tear or wear, could also be used for any or all of the transverse member **116**, body **110**, proximal flange **120**, and distal flange **130**. These materials include, but are not limited to, silicone, rubber, vinyl, polyurethane elastomers, or a combination of components, including styreneethylene-butylene-styrene (SEBS) block co-polymers, polyolefins, mineral oils, and silicone oils. All elements except the actuator **160** may be made of the same material, and may be formed as a single monolithic piece. In other examples, one or more element may be made of a different material.

(69) The actuator **160**, including the head **166**, shaft **162**, and clamp **164** may be made as a single monolithic piece. In other examples, one or more of the head **166**, shaft **162**, and clamp **164** may be

made of a different material. These materials include, but are not limited to, reinforced nylon, hard plastic such as polyvinylchloride (PVC), high-density polyethylene (HDPE), polystyrene (PS), polycarbonate, acrylonitrile butadiene styrene (ABS), and polypropylene (PP), and metal or metal alloys.

(70) While the different lengths of cannulas provide a good fit to a specific tissue thickness or depth, the clinician needs to determine the tissue thickness or depth before choosing a cannula length. In addition, tissue thicknesses or depths may alter during the surgical procedure, due to patient swelling and extravasation, potentially requiring multiple cannula lengths for the procedure. To more easily accommodate differing and changing tissue depths, a flexible cannula configured to be secured to various tissue thicknesses is desired.

(71) FIG. 8 shows a flexible cannula **1100** with a distal flange **1120** with relief slits or notches **1122** so the distal flange **1120** may be flexed proximally for insertion, which may allow the cannula **1100** to be inserted on an obturator, thus removing the need for a hemostat or other tool external to the cannula **1100**. A valve seals the passageway through the cannula **1100** both when an instrument is inserted through the passageway of the cannula **1100** and when no instrument is inserted therein.

(72) The cannula **1100** may include an elongated body **1110** having a shaft **1115** with a longitudinal axis, and a distal flange **1120**. The body **1110** may be formed of a flexible polymeric material. The cannula **1100** may include a cap **1150** disposed on the proximal end of the elongated body **1110**. The body **1110** defines a passageway or lumen **1111** extending along the longitudinal axis. When inserted into a skin incision, the cap **1150** may sit outside the joint space, on or above the skin, and serve as the entry point for the necessary devices for the procedure. The shaft **1115** may include an exterior structure configured to aid in inserting and retaining the cannula **1100** in the skin incision. In the example shown in FIG. 8, the exterior structure is a helical thread **1116**. When the cannula **1100** is screwed into the skin incision, the distal flange **1120** may sit inside the joint space and retract surrounding soft tissue to improve visualization inside the joint space.

(73) The distal flange **1120** may extend radially outward from the distal end of the body **1110**. The distal flange **1120** may be generally circular as illustrated, or oval, teardrop, or stadium in shape, and may have similar or different shapes and diameters. The distal flange **1120** may have relief elements so that the flange **1120** may easily bend back and forth between a first, biased radial configuration in which the distal flange **1120** extends radially outward from the body **1110**, as shown in FIG. 8, and a second, deflected or folded configuration in which the distal flange **1120** is bent proximally during insertion through a skin incision. It is noted that in some instances, the flange **1120** may be deflected or folded distally during insertion through a skin incision, if desired. The distal flange **1120** is biased in the radial configuration when not subjected to an external force. In one example, the relief elements include a plurality of notches **1122** cut into the outer perimeter **1124** of the distal flange **1120**. The notches **1122** may be triangular cuts with the widest part of the cut at the perimeter of the distal flange **1120** and side edges of the notches converging radially inwardly toward the longitudinal axis of the body **1110**, as shown in FIG. 8. In other embodiments, the notches **1122** may be circular, oval, or teardrop in shape.

(74) The cannula **1100** may be inserted using an obturator, extending through the lumen **1111**, as shown in FIG. 9. For example, the shaft of the obturator **1050** may be inserted through the passageway or lumen **1111** of the cannula **1100** to provide rigidity when passing the cannula **1100** through a skin incision. The distal tip of the shaft of the obturator **1050** may extend beyond the distal flange **1120** to facilitate insertion through a skin incision.

(75) The cannula **1100** illustrated in FIGS. 8-12 may include at least one valve **1130** secured to the body **1110** by a flexible cap **1150**. In some instances, the flexible cap **1150** forms a non-compressive seal with the valve **1130**. The non-compressive seal is configured to prevent or limit the amount of fluid escaping through the lumen **1111** of the cannula and to maintain the hydrostatic pressure inside the joint space, both when an instrument is inserted through the lumen **1111** and when no instrument is present in the lumen **1111**. The valve **1130** may be located within an interior

of the body **1110** adjacent the proximal end, as shown in FIG. **10**. The body **1110** may have a shoulder **1112** extending radially outward, with a proximally facing surface creating a seat for a circumferential flange **1132** on the valve **1130**. In some examples, the shoulder **1112** defines an undercut in which the proximally facing surface of the shoulder **1112** has a downward angle (i.e., is tapered distally in a radially outward direction), and the circumferential flange **1132** may have a mating distally facing surface having a downward angle (i.e., tapering distally in a radially outward direction). The cap **1150** may include a distal flange **1158** configured to engage the shoulder **1112** (e.g., interlock and/or form a snap-fit) to secure the cap **1150** onto the body **1110**. The cap **1150** is flexible, i.e., formed of a flexible polymeric material) to allow the distal flange **1158** to flex outward as it moves over the proximal end **1114** of the body **1110**, and then return to the biased configuration with the distal flange **1158** positioned under the shoulder **1112** as shown in FIG. **10**.

(76) The non-compressive seal may be formed by a tortuous pathway defined between the distally facing inner surface **1154** of the cap **1150** and the proximal surface **1134** of the valve **1130** which interfaces with (i.e., is juxtaposed with) the distally facing inner surface **1154**. In some examples, the tortuous pathway is defined by a non-linear proximal surface **1134** on the valve **1130** and a corresponding, complementary non-linear inner surface **1154** on the cap **1150**. The proximal surface **1134** of the valve **1130** may have a first mating geometry and the inner surface **1154** of the cap **1150** may have a second mating geometry complementary to the mating geometry of the proximal surface **1134**. When the cap **1150** is disposed on the valve **1130** within the body **1110** and the first mating geometry engages the second mating geometry such that the proximal surface **1134** of the valve **1130** is juxtaposed with the inner surface **1154** of the cap **1150**, a non-compressive seal is created therebetween. The tortuous pathway created between the inner surface **1154** of the cap **1150** and the proximal surface **1134** of the valve **1130** substantially prevents fluid from escaping from the lumen **1111** in the absence of compressive forces between the cap **1150**, valve **1130**, and body **1110**.

(77) Due to the non-compressive seal created between the cap **1150** and valve **1130**, the cap **1150** may be flexible, with a durometer the same as or less than the durometer of the body **1110**. In some examples, the cap **1150** may be a polymeric material (e.g., silicone) having a durometer of 80 Shore A or less. In other examples, the cap **1150** may have a durometer of 60 Shore A or less. The cap **1150** may also be elastic, in order to stretch around the valve **1130** and body **1110**. In some examples, the cap **1150** may have an elasticity from 100% to 300%, meaning the cap **1150** is formed from a material that can be extended elastically about 100 to 300 percent or more of its original length. The body **1110** may be a polymeric material (e.g., silicone) having a durometer of 80 Shore A or less. In other examples, the body **1110** may have a durometer of 60 Shore A or less. The cap **1150** may include a central opening **1152** configured to allow insertion of an instrument therethrough. Due to the flexible nature of the cap **1150**, the peripheral rim of the cap **1150** defining the opening **1152** may function as a secondary valve, sealing around the instrument inserted through the cannula **1100**. The relatively soft and flexible material of the cap **1150** also provides the advantage of ease of assembly in that the cap **1150** may be pushed onto the body **1110** with the distal flange **1158** flexing outward as it moves over the proximal end **1114** of the body **1110**, and then returning to the biased configuration with the distal flange **1158** positioned under the shoulder **1112**, as shown in FIG. **10**. In other examples, the inner surface **1154** may be a surface of a separate flexible ring fixed to a rigid cap **1150**.

(78) In one example, the tortuous pathway defining the non-compressive seal involves the first mating geometry on the proximal surface **1134** of the valve having at least one ridge **1135** and the second mating geometry on the inner surface **1154** of the cap **1150** having at least two ridges **1155** separated by a channel **1156** therebetween. When the cap **1150** engages the valve **1130**, the at least one ridge **1135** on the valve **1130** is received within the channel **1156** on the cap **1150**. In another example, the tortuous pathway defining the non-compressive seal involves the first mating geometry on the proximal surface **1134** of the valve having at least two ridges **1135** separated by a

channel therebetween and the second mating geometry on the inner surface **1154** of the cap **1150** having at least one ridge **1155** configured to be disposed in the channel. When the cap **1150** engages the valve **1130**, the at least one ridge **1155** on the cap **1150** is received within the channel on the valve **1130**. In the example valve **1130** illustrated in FIGS. **11A** and **11B**, the first mating geometry on the proximal surface **1134** of the valve **1130** includes two circumferential ridges **1135** separated by a channel **1136**. The matching second mating geometry on the cap **1150** is illustrated in FIG. **12**, and includes first, second, and third ridges **1155** separated by two channels **1156**. When the cap **1150** is disposed over the valve **1130** and body **1110**, as illustrated in FIG. **10**, the two ridges **1135** on the valve **1130** are received within the two channels **1156** on the cap **1150**.

(79) The valve **1130** may have an opening such as the cross slit **1133** illustrated in FIG. **11B**. In other examples, the opening may be a single slit, tri-slit or may be defined by any number of intersecting slits. The opening will be biased closed in the absence of any instrument disposed through the valve **1130**, and will seal around an instrument inserted through the valve **1130**.

(80) The cap **1150** may be more flexible than the body **1110**, and in some examples, the cap **1150** may also be more flexible than the valve **1130**. In some examples, the cap **1150** may be silicone or other flexible material, and may have a Shore A hardness of between 40 and 80. The body **1110** may be silicone or other flexible material, and may have a Shore A hardness of between 40 and 80. The valve **1130** may be made of a flexible material having a Shore A hardness of between 40 and 80. In some examples, the valve **1130** may be made of polyurethane (PU), rubber, neoprene, styrene block co-polymers (SBCs), or other thermoplastic elastomers. In some examples, the valve **1130** may be silicone. In some instances, the body **1110** may be made of the same materials as the valve **1130**, if desired.

(81) In some examples, the body **1110** may be cylindrical and may include a surface protrusion or texture that aids in securing the body **1110** within the skin incision. The surface protrusion or texture may further allow the body **1110** to be secured to a variety of depths of skin incision, providing the advantages of not requiring the user to determine the depth of skin incision prior to use, and providing a “one size fits all” body **1110** for use in a variety of depths of skin incision.

(82) FIGS. **13-15** illustrate another embodiment of a cannula **1200** that includes an elongated body **1210**, a first valve **1230**, a second valve **1260**, and a cap **1250**. The elongated body **1210** may be similar to the body **1110** described above, with the added feature of a plurality of tabs **1217** configured to extend through apertures **1257** in the cap **1250** to secure the cap **1250** to the body **1210**, as shown in FIG. **13**. The body **1210** may have a shaft **1215** with an exterior structure such as a helical thread **1216**, and a distal flange **1220** with notches **1222**, similar to the body **1110** described above.

(83) The cannula **1200** may include a first valve **1230** and a second valve **1260**, and the cap **1250** may be rigid and be connected to the body **1210** in a manner that compresses the first valve **1230** and second valve **1260** between the body **1210** and cap **1250** to form a compression seal. The second valve **1260** may be juxtaposed with a proximal surface of the first valve **1230**, in some instances. As shown in FIGS. **14** and **15**, the first valve **1230** may be similar to the valve **1130** discussed above, except for having a substantially planar proximal surface **1234**. The second valve **1260** may be shaped as a ring with a rim extending around a perimeter of a central opening **1262** configured to seal around an instrument inserted through the central opening **1262** and the passageway of the cannula **1200**. The second valve **1260** may have a planar proximal surface **1264** and a planar distal surface **1266**. The distally facing inner surface **1254** of the cap **1250** may also be planar. The first valve **1230**, second valve **1260**, and body **1210** may be made of the materials described above with reference to the valve **1130** and body **1110**, above.

(84) The first valve **1230** may be located within the body **1210** adjacent the proximal end, as shown in FIG. **14**. The body **1210** may have a shoulder **1212** extending radially outward, with a proximally facing surface creating a seat for a circumferential flange **1232** on the first valve **1230**. In some examples, the shoulder **1212** may define an undercut in which the proximally facing

surface of the shoulder **1112** has a downward angle (i.e., is tapered distally in a radially outward direction), and the circumferential flange **1232** may have a mating distally facing surface having a downward angle (i.e., tapering distally in a radially outward direction). The second valve **1260** may be placed over the first valve **1230** with the proximal surface **1234** of the first valve **1230** juxtaposed with and engaging the distal surface **1266** of the second valve **1260**. The cap **1250** is placed over the second valve **1260** with the proximal surface **1264** of the second valve **1260** engaging the distally facing inner surface **1254** of the cap **1250**. The tabs **1217** on the body **1210** extend through apertures **1257** in the cap **1250**, thereby securing the cap **1250** to the body **1210** and compressing the first and second valves **1230**, **1260** in a compression fit between the cap **1250** and the body **1210**.

(85) The valves **1130**, **1230**, **1260** may be made from a polymer material such as polyisoprene, to substantially reduce the amount of tearing or wear as a result of insertion and/or withdrawal of sharp instruments. The body **1110**, **1210** and flexible cap **1150** may also be made of polyisoprene. Other natural or synthetic materials known to one of ordinary skill in the art, and that would substantially reduce the amount of tear or wear, could also be used for any or all of the body **1110**, **1210**, valves **1130**, **1230**, **1260**, and flexible cap **1150**. These materials include, but are not limited to, silicone, rubber, vinyl, polyurethane elastomers, or a combination of components, including styreneethylene-butylene-styrene (SEBS) block co-polymers, polyolefins, mineral oils, and silicone oils. The rigid cap **1250** may be made of materials including, but not limited to, reinforced nylon, hard plastic such as polyvinylchloride (PVC), high-density polyethylene (HDPE), polystyrene (PS), polycarbonate, and polypropylene (PP), and metal or metal alloys. In some embodiments, the cannula **1100**, **1200** may include a rotatable member disposed around the elongated body **1110**, **1210** and configured to engage the exterior structure on the body **1110**, **1210** to secure the cannula to the skin incision. In one example, illustrated in FIGS. **16A** and **16B**, the rotatable member is a nut **1370** moveable axially and rotatably relative to the body **1310** to secure the cannula to a variety of skin incision depths, providing a 'one-size-fits-all' approach. It is noted that the body **1310** may be representative of the body **1110** of the cannula or the body **1210** of the cannula **1200** described above, and thus the discussion herein regarding the rotatable member (e.g., nut **1370**) is applicable to either embodiment described above. Only the body **1310** and nut **1370** are shown in FIGS. **16A-16B**, however it will be understood that the cannula will include the cap and one or two valves as discussed above.

(86) In the example illustrated in FIG. **16A**, the exterior structure on the elongated body **1310** includes a plurality of circumferential ribs **1316** spaced apart longitudinally along the body **1310**. Each rib **1316** is discontinuous (does not extend around the entire circumference of the body **1310**) and has a plurality of gaps **1318** between discontinuous segments of each rib **1316**, and the gaps **1318** of each rib **1316** are aligned longitudinally along the body **1310** at one or more common circumferential locations. The nut **1370** has a central opening having an inner circumference sized to move over the ribs **1316** (i.e., the radius of the central opening of the nut **1370** is greater than the radial extent of the ribs **1316** from the central longitudinal axis of the body **1310**). The nut **1370** may have a plurality of (i.e., two or more) projections **1372** extending inwardly from the inner surface of the nut **1370** into the central opening. The projections **1372** may be rigid and sized and spaced to slide through the gaps **1318**, allowing the nut **1370** to slide axially along the body **1310** when the nut **1370** is in the first position shown in FIG. **16A**. In other words, the projections **1372** may be arranged at the same angular or circumferential positions as the gaps **1318**, such that the projections **1372** can travel longitudinally through the gaps **1318** when rotatably aligned therewith. The ability of the nut **1370** to slide axially along the gaps **1318** provides for a rapid insertion and adjustment of the depth of the cannula. This provides an advantage over a conventionally threaded nut and shaft.

(87) For insertion into an incision, the nut **1370** is moved to the proximal end of the body **1310**. Once the body **1310** of the cannula is inserted and the flange **1320** is disposed in the joint space,

the nut **1370** is rotated to the first position with the projections **1372** rotatably aligned with the gaps **1318** (see FIG. **16A**) and the nut **1370** is slid axially distally until the nut **1370** engages the skin. The nut **1370** may then be rotated to a second position, with the projections **1372** between adjacent ribs **1316** and out of rotational alignment with the gaps **1318**, as shown in FIG. **16B**. The projections **1372** abut the ribs **1316**, preventing the nut **1370** from moving axially, keeping the body **1310** in place within the incision. In some examples, the projections **1372** may be sized to contact both the rib **1316** above and the rib **1316** below the projection **1372**, providing a friction fit between the ribs **1316** and the projections **1372** as the nut **1370** is rotated. This may prevent the nut **1370** from inadvertently rotating during use until the projections **1372** are in the gap **1318** and allowing the nut **1370** to move axially. The friction fit may be overcome by manually rotating the nut **1370** once the procedure is complete. The adjustable nut **1370** allows the cannula to be used with incisions of varying depth, removing the need for having multiple length cannulas on hand. Further, as tissue thickness can change, and oftentimes expands during procedures, due to general swelling and/or extravasation, the nut **1370** may be rotated to the first position shown in FIG. **16A** and slid proximally or distally to accommodate the changing incision depth, and then rotated back to the second position shown in FIG. **16B** to secure the cannula. Accordingly, the longitudinal distance between the nut **1370** and the distal flange **1320** can be adjusted as desired to accommodate any thickness of tissue constrained therebetween when the cannula is inserted through a skin incision.

(88) FIGS. **17A** and **17B** illustrate two embodiments of nut **1470**, **1370** with two or three projections **1472**, **1372**, respectively. It will be understood that the number and/or position of projections **1472**, **1372** should correspond with the number and/or position of gaps **1318**. The nuts **1470**, **1370** may be symmetrically arranged around the circumference of the opening of the nut **1470**, **1370**. As shown in FIG. **17A**, a nut **1470** with two projections **1472** may be configured such that the projections **1472** are positioned 180 degrees apart. As shown in FIG. **17B**, a nut **1370** with three projections **1372** may be configured such that the projections **1372** are positioned 120 degrees apart. A nut with four projections may have its projections positioned 90 degrees apart.

(89) In some examples, the surface protrusion or texture on the body that engages the nut may be helical threading. FIG. **18** illustrates an elongated body **1410** of a cannula (valve(s) and cap not shown) with discontinuous threads **1416** interrupted by a series of gaps **1418** aligned longitudinally along the body **1410**. In other words, the elongated body **1410** may include discontinuous helical threading with gaps **1418** between discontinuous segments of the helical threading. Each segment of the threading may extend less than 360 degrees, or less than 180 degrees around the circumference of the body **1410**, for example. The gaps **1418** may be aligned longitudinally along the body **1410** at one or more common circumferential locations. In this embodiment the body **1410** has a plurality of stops to limit rotation of the nut (not shown). As illustrated, the stops are detents or recesses **1419** in the outer surface of the body **1410**. The recesses **1419** are sized and shaped to receive a portion of the projections **1372**, **1472** on the nut **1370**, **1470**. When the nut **1370**, **1470** is rotated, the projections **1372**, **1472** may engage the outer surface of the body **1410** in a tight fit that allows for rotation. When the projections **1372**, **1472** are rotated into the recesses **1419**, a portion of the projections **1372**, **1472** is received within the recesses **1419**, preventing further rotation until a greater rotational force is applied to the nut **1370**, **1470**.

(90) In another example, the stop limiting rotation of the nut **1370**, **1470** may be an outwardly extending protrusion **1519** on the outer surface of the body **1510**. In the example illustrated in FIG. **19**, the body **1510** of the cannula has a discontinuous helical thread **1516** with a plurality of circumferentially aligned gaps **1518** and a plurality of protrusions **1519** positioned adjacent the gaps **1518**. The protrusions **1519** may be provided on the distal side of each thread segment, with the thread segment extending helically from the protrusion **1519** toward the distal flange **1520** at the distal end of the body **1510**. When the nut **1370**, **1470** (not shown) is moved axially down the body **1510** into position against the skin and then rotated, the protrusions **1519** limit the movement

of the nut **1370**, **1470** when the projections **1372**, **1472** of the nut **1370**, **1470** abut the protrusions **1519**, helping to maintain the nut **1370**, **1470** in position to secure the cannula in the incision. The flange **1520** is illustrated as a substantially planar structure with flat distal and proximal surfaces. (91) In the example illustrated in FIGS. **20A** and **20B**, the body **1610** of the cannula (valve(s) and cap not shown) has a plurality of longitudinally spaced apart discontinuous ribs **1616**. Each rib **1616** has a plurality of circumferentially aligned gaps **1618** with a protrusion **1619** adjacent each gap **1618**. Similar to the protrusions **1519** on the helical thread **1516** shown in FIG. **19**, the protrusions **1619** limit the rotation of the nut **1370**, **1470** and help secure the cannula, preventing the nut **1370**, **1470** from accidental rotation into the adjacent gap **1618**. As shown in the cross-sectional view in FIG. **20B**, the ribs **1616** are rectangular, with proximal and distal surfaces substantially perpendicular to the longitudinal axis x-x of the body **1610**. The flange **1620** is wedge shaped in cross-section, with a proximal surface **1621** substantially perpendicular to the longitudinal axis x-x and a distal surface **1622** angled proximally as it extends from the body **1610**. The wedge shaped flange **1620** may aid in keeping the cannula in place in the incision, preventing the flange **1620** from being bent distally, while allowing for the flange **1620** to be bent proximally during insertion.

(92) FIGS. **21A**, **21B**, and **21C** illustrate a body **1710** of a cannula (valve(s) and cap not shown) with the nut **1370** in place. The body **1710** as illustrated is similar to the body **1610** shown in FIGS. **20A** and **20B**, but the ribs **1716** are wedge shaped and have angled distal surfaces **1713**, as shown in FIG. **21B**. FIG. **21C** shows the projections **1372** on the nut **1370** abutting the protrusions **1719** adjacent each gap **1718**.

(93) FIGS. **22A** and **22B** illustrate a body **1810** of a cannula (valve(s) and cap not shown) with a nut **1870** in place. The nut **1870** is similar to the nut **1370** described above, and has a plurality of projections **1872** extending inward. The body **1810** as illustrated is similar to the bodies **1610** and **1710**, but the longitudinally spaced apart ribs **1816** are rounded and extend entirely (e.g., continuously) circumferentially around the body **1810** with no gaps. FIG. **22B** shows the projections **1872** on the nut **1870** disposed in the space between adjacent but longitudinally spaced apart ribs **1816**. The nut **1870** and projections **1872** may be made of a material that is more rigid than the body **1810** such that when the nut **1870** is moved longitudinally, the body **1810** flexes inward, allowing the projections **1872** on the nut **1870** to move over the ribs **1816**. In other examples, the projections **1872** may be more flexible than the body **1810** such that the projections **1872** flex upwards or downwards as the nut **1870** moves longitudinally over the ribs **1816**. In some examples, the projections **1872** may be sized to contact both the rib **1816** above and the rib **1816** below the projection **1872** simultaneously, providing a friction fit between the ribs **1816** and the projections **1872** as the nut **1870** is rotated, as discussed above.

(94) There are existing elastomeric valves that serve as components of surgical access devices, such as trocars and cannulas in minimally invasive procedures. Some such valves include duckbill valves, cross-slit valves, and dome valves. The common characteristics between all of these valves are that they are passive, normally closed valves that create a fluid seal when oriented in a specific configuration, as fluid pressure forces the valve closed. In surgical access devices, these valves are used to prevent fluid (gas or liquid) from leaking through surgical portals created via a skin incision. A shortcoming of conventional valves arises when a medical instrument is inserted through the valve, as an opening is created by the surgical instrument disrupting the seal of the valve and permitting fluid to leak past the interface between the surgical instrument and the valve. Due to this leakage, these elastomeric valves are generally combined with a secondary valve that creates a seal around the medical instrument. This two-stage valve design is present in many arthroscopic and laparoscopic trocars and cannulas.

(95) The duckbill valve **2100** shown in FIGS. **23-29**, which may be incorporated into a surgical access device, solves the leakage problem and prevents loss of distention fluid while allowing medical instruments to enter the surgical access devices as needed. The valve **2100** may be made of

an elastomeric material such as silicone or polyurethane, and has a geometry that creates a fluid seal both with and without a medical instrument inserted through the valve **2100**. The geometry includes an arcuate cutout **2180** sized to accommodate the medical instrument to be inserted through the valve **2100**. The arcuate cutout **2180** allows the valve **2100** to create a fluid seal around the perimeter of a medical instrument passed therethrough, as well as providing a fluid seal without the medical instrument present, removing the need for a two-stage valve system commonly required to achieve a satisfactory seal.

(96) The valve **2100** may be a duckbill valve including a body member **2105** having a base **2110** and first and second opposing walls **2120**, **2130** extending from the base **2110**. See FIGS. 23-24B. In some examples, the body member **2105** may include a flange **2102** extending radially outward from the base **2110** beyond the perimeter of the base **2110**. The flange **2102** may be sized and configured to be coupled with a cannula. The flange **2102** may extend circumferentially around the base **2110**. In other examples, the flange **2102** may extend only partially around the base **2110**.

(97) The first and second walls **2120**, **2130** may be mirror images of one another. The first and second walls **2120**, **2130** may have first ends **2122**, **2132** spaced apart at the base **2110** and second ends **2124**, **2134** converging at a lower surface **2128** of the valve **2100**. In some examples, the lower surface **2128** may be substantially perpendicular to the central axis x-x, as shown in FIG. 23. The arcuate cutout **2180** may be provided at the second ends **2124**, **2134** of the first and second walls **2120**, **2130**. The arcuate cutout **2180** may be centered on the central axis x-x of the body member **2105**, as shown in FIG. 23. The first and second walls **2120**, **2130** may each define a plurality of planes. In the example shown in FIG. 23, each wall **2120**, **2130** has side planes **2142** and a center plane **2145**. The side planes **2142** may extend from the lower surface toward the base **2110** at a different angle than the center plane **2145**.

(98) The lower surface **2128** may include a slit **2140** extending at least partially along the length of the lower surface **2128**. In some examples, the length S of the slit **2140** (measured perpendicular to the central axis x-x) may be less than the length L of the lower surface **2128** (measured perpendicular to the central axis x-x), as shown in FIG. 24A. The length S of the slit **2140** is measured linearly across the lower surface **2128**. In the example shown in FIG. 24A, the length S of the slit **2140** is greater than the length R of the arcuate cutout **2180** (measured perpendicular to the central axis x-s), with the slit **2140** extending laterally beyond the arcuate cutout **2180** but not completely across the lower surface **2128**. Thus, the slit **2140** may have a length S greater than the length R of the arcuate cutout **2180**, but less than the length L of the lower surface **2128** of the valve **2100**.

(99) The arcuate cutout **2180**, which may be centered along the lower surface **2128**, divides the lower surface **2128** into first and second sections **2129** positioned on opposite lateral sides of the arcuate cutout **2180**. In some instances, the slit **2140** may extend to about the midpoint of each section **2129**, as shown in FIG. 24A. In other examples, the length of the slit **2140** may be equal to or less than the length R of the arcuate cutout **2180** (e.g., equal to or less than the diameter of the arcuate cutout **2180**). For example the length S of the slit **2140** is shown to be equal to the length R of the arcuate cutout **2180** (e.g., equal to the diameter of the arcuate cutout **2180**), as shown in FIG. 24B. The slit **2140** may have a length of between 0.1 inches and 0.8 inches, between 0.3 inches and 0.5 inches, between 0.2 inches and 0.4 inches, about 0.2 inches, about 0.3 inches, or about 0.4 inches, for example. In one example, the slit has a length of 0.4 inches. The slit **2140** may have a width or thickness of 0.03 inches or less, such as between 0.01 inches and 0.03 inches, or between 0.00 inches and 0.03 inches, for example. A slit having a width or thickness of 0.00 inches refers to an embodiment in which a slit is formed, but due to the nature of the elastic properties of the valve **2100** the walls **2120**, **2130** on either side of the slit collapse against one another effectively removing any gap therebetween. Thus while there is a slit, it has a width or thickness of 0.00 inches when the walls **2120**, **2130** are in direct contact with one another. Similarly, when no instrument is inserted through the valve **2100**, fluid exerts radial pressure on the outside of the walls **2120**, **2130**,

forcing the second ends **2124**, **2134** together and closing the slit **2140** thereby preventing fluid from egressing through the valve **2100**.

(100) Upon insertion of an instrument through the valve **2100**, the slit **2140** expands and the edge of the arcuate cutout **2180** seals around the perimeter of the instrument, allowing the second ends **2124**, **2134** of the walls to pinch closed on either side of the arcuate cutout **2180** even though the slit **2140** is longer than the length of the arcuate cutout **2180**. Thus, the valve **2100** maintains a fluid seal around the medical device inserted therethrough.

(101) The length R of the arcuate cutout **2180**, which in some instances may be a diameter of the arcuate cutout **2180**, may be less than the length L of the lower surface **2128**. In some instances, the length R of the arcuate cutout **2180**, which in some instances may be a diameter of the arcuate cutout **2180**, may be less than one-half the length L of the lower surface **2128**. In some instances, the radius of the arcuate cutout **2180** may be less than one-half the length L of the lower surface **2128**, as shown in FIG. 25A. In some examples, the length L of the lower surface **2128** may be between 0.5 inches and 1.0 inch and the length R may be between 0.1 inches and 0.4 inches. In one example, the length L is 0.6 inches and the length R is 0.2 inches, while the length of the slit **2140** is 0.4 inches. Thus, the slit **2140**, which may have a length greater than the length R of the cutout **2180**, may extend about 0.1 inches beyond each end of the cutout **2180** in this example. The length S of the slit **2140** may be 4 times or less than the radius of the arcuate cutout **2180**, in some examples. In some instances, the length S of the slit **2140** may be less than or equal to twice the radius of the arcuate cutout **2180**.

(102) In some examples, the arcuate cutout **2180** may define a semi-circle, with the depth D being equal to the radius, and thus equal to one-half of the length R, as shown in FIG. 25A. In one example, the radius of a semi-circular arcuate cutout **2180** is 0.1 inches. The length R of the arcuate cutout **2180** may be matched to the diameter of the instrument to be inserted through the valve **2100**. The length R of the arcuate cutout **2180** may generally be slightly larger than the diameter of the instrument to be inserted through the valve **2100**, but still provide a good seal around the instrument. In some examples, the length R of the arcuate cutout **2180** may be no more than 0.02 inches larger than the diameter of the instrument to be inserted through the valve **2100**, or no more than 0.05 inches larger than the diameter of the instrument to be inserted through the valve **2100**. In other examples the arcuate cutout **2180** may be U-shaped, with the depth D of the arcuate cutout **2180** being greater than the radius of the arcuate cutout **2180** and/or the length R of the arcuate cutout **2180**, as shown in FIG. 25B. For example, the depth D may be between 0.15 inches and 0.45 inches, in some instances.

(103) Referring to FIG. 24A, the center plane **2145** of each wall **2120**, **2130** may include converging edges **2160** where the center plane **2145** intersects the side planes **2142**. The edges **2160** may extend to a corner **2162** where the arcuate cutout **2180** intersects the lower surface **2128** of the valve **2100**. The center plane **2145** may be oriented at an oblique angle to the central axis x-x extending through the valve **2100**. Accordingly, the thickness T at the lower end surface **2128** of each of the first and second walls **2120**, **2130** may be constant along the entire length of the slit **2140**. See FIG. 23A. In other words, the lower end surface **2128** of each of the first and second walls **2120**, **2130** may have a constant wall thickness T from the first end of the slit **2140**, along the lower end surface **2128** of a first section **2129**, along the arcuate cutout **2180**, along the lower end surface **2128** of a second section **2129**, to the second end of the slit **2140**.

(104) As shown in the cross-sectional view of FIG. 26, the valve **2100** may define an axial passageway **2104** extending from the base **2110** to the lower end surface **2128** through the slit **2140** and the arcuate cutout **2180**. The first ends **2122**, **2132** of the first and second walls **2120**, **2130** may define a curve adjacent the base **2110**, as shown in FIG. 27. The inner surfaces **2121**, **2131** of the first and second walls **2120**, **2130** may be smooth and devoid of projections or depressions, if desired. As shown in FIG. 27, the first and second walls **2120**, **2130** may each have a thickness **2125**, **2135** that is constant from the first end **2122**, **2132** to the second end **2124**, **2134** of each

wall, if desired. Furthermore, the wall thickness **2125**, **2135** may also be constant from one end of the slit **2140**, across the arcuate cutout **2180** to the other end of the slit, as shown in FIG. **26**. The center plane **2145** of each wall **2120**, **2130** may create this constant wall thickness. Turning to FIG. **28**, when an instrument **2190** is inserted through the valve **2100** during use, the arcuate cutout **2180** may closely follow the perimeter of the instrument **2190** such that the edge of the arcuate cutout **2180** forms a fluid seal around the circumference of the instrument **2190**. Furthermore, fluid within the surgical site may further exert radial pressure on the outside of the walls **2120**, **2130**, forcing the second ends **2124**, **2134** together to seal the slit **2140** in the sections **2129** on either side of the arcuate cutout **2180**, as shown in FIG. **28**.

(105) FIG. **29** illustrates the valve **2100** in an access cannula **2192**, with the flange **2102** of the valve **2100** attached to a cap **2194** of the cannula **2192**. The cannula may include an elongate body defining an access lumen extending therethrough. The valve **2100** may be disposed within the access lumen. A medical device, illustrated as a tendon stapler **2190** that may be used in arthroscopic surgeries, is inserted through the access lumen of the cannula **2192**. For example, the shaft of the tendon stapler **2190** may be inserted through the slit **2140** of the valve **2100**, with the arcuate cutout **2180** sealing around the perimeter of the shaft of the tendon stapler **2190**.

(106) FIG. **30** illustrates another variation of a duckbill valve **2200** including an arcuate cutout **2280**. The lower end of the valve **2200** may have an H-shape when viewed from the bottom, as shown in FIG. **30**. The first and second opposing walls **2220**, **2230** have extensions **2250**, **2350** on laterally opposite sides extending laterally away from the center plane **2245**. Furthermore, the slit **2240** may have an H-shape, with opposing end segments of the slit **2240** extending perpendicular to the central portion of the slit **2240** traversing the arcuate cutout **2280**. The end segments of the slit **2240** extend into the extensions **2250**, **2350**. The arcuate cutout **2280** may be similar to the arcuate cutout **2180** described above. Therefore, the above description of the arcuate cutout **2180** is also applicable to the arcuate cutout **2280**, and thus will not be repeated. The arcuate cutout **2280** may function as described above, sealing around an instrument while the portions of the slit **2240** extending away from the arcuate cutout **2280** are pushed together to close the slit **2240** when fluid exerts radial pressure. All other features may be the same as described above for the valve **2100**.

(107) The valve **2100**, **2200** may be made from a polymer material such as polyisoprene, to substantially reduce the amount of tearing or wear as a result of insertion and/or withdrawal of sharp instruments. Other natural or synthetic materials known to one of ordinary skill in the art, and that would substantially reduce the amount of tear or wear, could also be used for any or all of the elements of the valve **2100**, **2200**. These materials include, but are not limited to, silicone, rubber, vinyl, polyurethane elastomers, or a combination of components, including styreneethylene-butylene-styrene (SEBS) block co-polymers, polyolefins, mineral oils, and silicone oils.

(108) The entire valve **2100**, **2200** may be made as a single monolithic piece. In other examples, one or more of the flange **2102**, body member **2105**, base **2110**, and first and second walls **2120**, **2130** may be made of a different material and attached to the remaining elements, such as by heat seal, co-molding, over-molding, or adhesive.

(109) FIG. **31** illustrates another example cannula **300** configured to be used with a tissue stapler (e.g., tendon stapler), or other medical device, that allows for the insertion of the cannula **300** simultaneously with tissue stapler into the joint space for anchor deployment. The cannula **300** may include a flexible sheath **302** configured to surround the majority of the distal tip of the elongate shaft **334** of the tissue stapler **330**, as shown in FIG. **32**. The cannula **300** may include a lumen **301** extending therethrough with a slit **304** extending the entire length of the sheath **302**, from the distal end **306** of the sheath **302** to the proximal end **308** of the sheath **302**. The slit **304** allows for the cannula **300** to be placed around the shaft **334** by inserting the shaft **334** laterally through the slit **304** and to be removed laterally from the shaft **334** of the tissue stapler **330** by pulling the cannula **300** laterally relative to the shaft **334** such that the shaft **334** passes laterally out through the slit **304**. In some examples, the tissue stapler **330** may be provided with the sheath **302** pre-assembled

with the tissue stapler 330 such that the sheath 302 is surrounding the distal tip region of the shaft 334, as shown in FIG. 33A. Thus, the sheath 302 may surround and protect the prongs 340 of the tissue stapler 330 from contact with tissue 350 during insertion of the tissue stapler 300 through an incision. As shown in FIG. 33B, the combination tissue stapler 330 with attached cannula 300 may be inserted into an incision 352 through tissue 350 of the patient directly from the packaging, with the sheath 302 protecting the surrounding tissue while the shaft 334 of the tissue stapler 330 acts as an obturator.

(110) Once the distal end 306 of the cannular 300 and the instrument contained therein are in the proper location, for example, in the shoulder joint space, the curved or flared proximal end 308 may be grasped and pulled proximally from exterior of the patient's body, such as exterior of an incision of the shoulder region. This pulls the sheath 302 back up the shaft 334 of the tissue stapler 330 with the slit 304 allowing for removal from the shaft 334 in a sideways or lateral manner, leaving the shaft 334 of the tissue stapler 330 within the patients' anatomy through the incision 352 alone without a cannula, as shown in FIG. 33C.

(111) The proximal end 308 may have a flared region or petal shape, as illustrated in FIG. 31. The flared proximal end 308 may prevent the cannula 300 from being inserted into the incision and provide a lip for the user to grasp for withdrawal. In other examples, the distal end 306 of the cannula 300 may have a bullnosed recess that partially protects the sharp prongs 340 of the tissue stapler 330. The cannula 300 may provide the advantage of reducing the surgical steps when compared to the previously used cannula and providing protection from the prongs 340 of the tissue stapler 330 during insertion, as well as during packaging and back-table handoffs.

(112) The above detailed description includes references to the accompanying drawings, which form a part of the detailed description. The drawings show, by way of illustration, specific embodiments in which the invention can be practiced. These embodiments are also referred to herein as "examples." Such examples can include elements in addition to those shown or described. However, the present inventors also contemplate examples in which only those elements shown or described are provided. Moreover, the present inventors also contemplate examples using any combination or permutation of those elements shown or described (or one or more aspects thereof), either with respect to a particular example (or one or more aspects thereof), or with respect to other examples (or one or more aspects thereof) shown or described herein.

Claims

1. A cannula for passing surgical instruments through tissue, comprising: an elongated body having a distal end, a proximal end, and a lumen extending along a longitudinal axis therebetween, wherein the elongated body is cylindrical and defined by a solid outer wall extending continuously around an entire circumference of the cylindrical elongated body and extending continuously axially from the distal end to the proximal end, the elongated body includes a plurality of circumferential ribs disposed on an outer surface of the elongated body; a flange extending radially outward from the distal end; a valve disposed within the lumen of the elongated body adjacent the proximal end; a cap configured to be disposed over the proximal end of the elongated body, the cap configured to secure the valve to the elongated body; a nut extending around a circumference of the elongated body and axially slidable along the elongate body, the nut configured to selectively engage the circumferential ribs to retain a position thereof; wherein the cap engages the valve to create a non-compressive seal therebetween; wherein a proximal surface of the valve has a first mating geometry and an inner surface of the cap has a second mating geometry, wherein the non-compressive seal is created between the valve and the cap when the first mating geometry of the valve engages the second mating geometry of the cap; wherein the first mating geometry of the valve includes at least one ridge and the second mating geometry of the cap includes at least two ridges separated by a channel, wherein when the cap engages the valve, the at least one ridge on the

valve is received within the channel on the cap.

2. The cannula of claim 1, wherein the nut has a length measured parallel to the longitudinal axis of the elongate body, wherein the length is greater than a distance between two adjacent ones of the circumferential ribs.
 3. The cannula of claim 1, wherein the flange has an outer diameter, and the nut extends radially outward from the longitudinal axis of the elongate body beyond the outer diameter of the flange.
 4. The cannula of claim 1, wherein the nut has a proximal region and a distal region, the distal region having a radial outer extent greater than the proximal region.
 5. A cannula for passing surgical instruments through tissue, comprising: an elongated body having a distal end, a proximal end, and a lumen extending along a longitudinal axis therebetween, wherein the elongated body is cylindrical and includes a plurality of circumferential ribs disposed on an outer surface of the elongated body; a flange extending radially outward from the distal end; a valve disposed within the lumen of the elongated body adjacent the proximal end; a cap configured to be disposed over the proximal end of the elongated body, the cap configured to secure the valve to the elongated body; and a nut extending around a circumference of the elongated body and axially slidable along the elongate body, the nut configured to selectively engage the circumferential ribs to retain a position thereof; wherein the cap is more flexible than the elongated body and the valve.
 6. A cannula for passing surgical instruments through tissue comprising: an elongated body having a distal end, a proximal end, and a lumen extending along a longitudinal axis therebetween, wherein the elongated body is cylindrical and defined by a solid outer wall extending continuously around an entire circumference of the cylindrical elongated body and extending continuously axially from the distal end to the proximal end, the elongated body includes a plurality of circumferential ribs disposed on an outer surface of the elongated body; a flange extending radially outward from the distal end; a valve disposed within the lumen of the elongated body adjacent the proximal end; a cap configured to be disposed over the proximal end of the elongated body, the cap configured to secure the valve to the elongated body; a nut extending around a circumference of the elongated body and axially slidable along the elongate body, the nut configured to selectively engage the circumferential ribs to retain a position thereof; wherein the nut is configured to selectively engage the circumferential ribs and to move between a first position in which the nut is disengaged from the circumferential ribs, allowing the nut to slide axially along the elongated body, and a second position in which the nut engages the circumferential ribs; wherein the circumferential ribs are discontinuous and include at least one gap, the gaps of adjacent circumferential ribs aligned longitudinally along a portion of the elongated body, wherein the nut has an inner circumference sized to move over the circumferential ribs and at least one inwardly extending rigid projection, wherein when the nut is rotated such that the projection is aligned with the gaps, the nut slides axially along the elongated body, and when the nut is rotated such that the projection is not aligned with the gaps, the projection engages the circumferential ribs and prevents the nut from moving axially along the elongated body; and wherein a stop is disposed adjacent each gap, the stop configured to limit rotation of the projection.
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